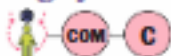


2. The Fortunate Pedlar



Warm-up Do you dream at night? Sometimes, do you dream during the day too? What do you dream about? Make a list of some of the things you have seen in your dreams and share it with the class.



I dreamt that I had a bear in my bedroom ...

 *This is a popular English folktale. It tells us about a pedlar who believes in his dream.*

 Hundreds of years ago, there lived a pedlar in a place called Norfolk in England. He went from one place to another, selling things.

One day the pedlar told his wife, "Last night, I had a dream. It is strange that I have been having the same dream for the past week."

"What did you dream of?" asked his wife.

pedlar

a person who goes from place to place selling small goods

strange

odd; unusual



The pedlar told her that he had heard a voice in his dream. Every time, the voice repeated, "If you stand on the London Bridge, you will hear good news."

At first, the pedlar did not bother to go to London. It was difficult for him. He would have to walk a long way to reach there. He would have to sleep under trees along the way. But the dream persisted. The pedlar got upset.

He called out to his wife, "I must go to London and stand on the bridge. Otherwise, I will have no peace."

The pedlar packed a few things, food and some money. He walked all the way and reached the London Bridge. The London Bridge was a busy place. There were houses and shops on either side. Every day, the pedlar stood on the bridge. But no one spoke to him or gave him good news. He felt like a fool for having gone there. Still he waited with hope.

One day, he had no food or money left. He decided to return home. Just then, a shopkeeper came out of his shop.

"Please tell me something," the shopkeeper enquired, "I have seen you here for so many days. You do not buy or sell anything. Why do you stand here?"

The pedlar told him about his dream. The man started laughing.



persisted
enquired

continued
asked (for information)





"Never believe in dreams," he said, "I too keep having a dream. The voice in the dream insists that I must go to a place called Norfolk. I must find a pedlar's house there. If I dig under the oak tree in his garden, I will find treasure. It is all nonsense. Even if I make the long journey to Norfolk, I am sure I will not find anything there. So forget the dream and go home."

On hearing this, the pedlar hurried home to Norfolk. He went to his garden. Then he began digging under the oak tree. He soon found a chest full of gold coins. He was no longer poor. He lived happily for the rest of his life.

It is said that he had a statue made of himself with his pack on his back. The statue showed him walking towards the London Bridge, the place where he had heard the good news.

insists

says firmly

treasure

very valuable things, usually in the form of precious metals, precious stones or money

chest

large, strong box





Reading

(reading for main ideas)

A. Discuss with you partner and answer these questions.



1. Where did the pedlar live?
2. What did the pedlar do for a living?
3. What did he tell his wife?
4. Why didn't he bother to go to London at first?

(reading for inference; HOTS)



B. Choose the right options to answer these questions. Work in pairs and check each other's answers.



1. Why did the pedlar finally decide to go to London?
 - a. He wanted peace of mind as the dream persisted.
 - b. His wife advised him to follow his dream.
 - c. He was curious about the dream.
 - d. He was eager to find the treasure.
2. Why did the pedlar feel like a fool in London?
 - a. His wife used to make fun of him.
 - b. People laughed at him for standing on the bridge.
 - c. Every day, he stood on the bridge waiting for something to happen, but it didn't.
 - d. He was worried about wasting money for no reason.



C. Think and answer.



1. How did the shopkeeper's words help the pedlar fulfil his dream?
2. Why do you think the pedlar had a statue made of himself?

D. Discuss in class.



perseverance

(value-based questions)

1. What do you think was the most important thing that helped the pedlar achieve success? Remember, there can be more than one thing.
2. Just like the pedlar was hopeful and did not give up on his dream easily, can you think of times when you did not give up on something and how it helped you?





Using Grammar

(singular and plural nouns)

Nouns can be either **singular** (that is, one) or **plural**, (that is, more than one).

• boy – boys

• table – tables



In these words, we form the plural noun by adding **-s** to the singular noun.

A. Write these words in the plural form. Choose any six objects from your surroundings and find out the plural forms for those.

- | | | | | |
|----------|-----------|-----------|----------|----------|
| 1. coin | 2. garden | 3. statue | 4. shop | 5. year |
| 6. thing | 7. dream | 8. tree | 9. house | 10. week |

Sometimes, we need to add an **-es** to the noun to make it plural.

box – boxes

B. Work in pairs and write these words in the plural form.

- | | | | | |
|----------|----------|----------|----------|-----------|
| 1. watch | 2. brush | 3. bunch | 4. bus | 5. church |
| 6. class | 7. glass | 8. dish | 9. dress | 10. fox |

(articles **a, an, the**)

Read this sentence.

A shopkeeper met the pedlar under an old bridge.

We use **a** and **an** to talk about something for the first time or something that is not specific. These words are **indefinite articles**. Note that **a** is used before words that begin with a consonant sound and **an** is used before words that begin with a vowel sound.

Now notice the use of **the** in the sentence given above. Over here, we are talking about someone definite, someone particular, someone who has been mentioned earlier too. **The** is called the **definite article**.



C. Complete this paragraph with suitable articles. Show your answers to your teacher.



Under _____ oak tree lay _____ chest full of many valuable things. It contained _____ old gold coin, _____ big medal, _____ beautiful box and _____ astonishing piece of jewellery.

The pedlar and his wife were so delighted with their riches that they lived happily ever after. They took great care of _____ tree and used _____ chest to store all their beautiful things.



Using Words

(homophones)



A **homophone** is a word that is pronounced the same as another word but has a different meaning and spelling.

- one – won
- see – sea

The pedlar wrote of his experience but made a few mistakes. Correct the errors by replacing the highlighted words. Use a dictionary and write the meanings of the highlighted words and the new words you replaced them with. Note the differences in spelling and meaning.



I have a **tail** to tell. **Won** day, I decided to do what my dream asked me **two**. I went and stood on the London Bridge and waited patiently to **here** **sum** good news. I was sure that my dream would come true. It was some **daze** before a shopkeeper spoke to me and told me of his dream. I soon realised that his dream was the key to mine. So, I hurried home and dug under the oak tree where I found a chest full of **grate** things. My wife was very happy too and we were never poor again.



Dictionary Work

(alphabetical order)

Words in a dictionary are always arranged in alphabetical order. This means they are arranged according to the order of the letters in the alphabet. Look at these words.



• ace • chest • bridge • dig • food • enough

1 Bring a pocket dictionary to class. Work in pairs and arrange the words in alphabetical order. Share your answers with another pair and check each other's answers.

ask, dream, hurry, news, rough, umbrella, walk, zoom, busy



Assessment of Speaking and Listening



Listening

(listening for details)

1 Listen to this passage about the London Bridge and then fill in the blanks. Check your answers.

The London Bridge is a _____ bridge in London that goes over River Thames. It has actually been replaced _____ times during its _____. In around 55 CE, the Romans _____ the first London Bridge. A huge _____ destroyed the bridge in 1091. It was then _____ on 19 arches. It had a drawbridge at each end to _____ tall ships to pass through it. Work on the first London Bridge started in 1967 and was _____ in 1972. The nursery _____ 'London Bridge Is Falling Down' refers to the many _____ the bridge has been _____ and rebuilt.

Pronunciation

(consonant sounds in pin and big)

1 A. Say these words aloud. Notice that the letters in bold in these words have the same sound. Check with your teacher for correct pronunciation.

pin pick happy dip hop pair



B. Now say these words aloud. Notice that the letters in **bold** in these words have the same sound. Work in pairs and check your peer's pronunciation.

big beat bag baby **born** rub

Speaking

(speaking on a topic)

You read a story of the pedlar who waited on the bridge. Now look at this picture of a girl on a bridge. Read the hints given below. Work in pairs and take turns to describe the picture.



lovely day—fluffy

white clouds—

blue sky—girl

standing on

bridge—looks

happy—holding

colourful

balloons—river

flowing under

bridge—beautiful

trees and mountains



You may begin like this: *It was a lovely day with fluffy white clouds ...*



Writing

(describing a picture)

In the Speaking section, you worked with a partner and took turns to describe the picture above. Now write three sentences about it. Show your answers to your teacher.





Punctuation

(question mark)

A **question mark** is placed at the end of a sentence to indicate that we are asking something and are seeking an answer.

“What did you dream of?” the pedlar’s wife asked the pedlar.

A. Correct the errors in punctuation in this paragraph. Check with your teacher for correct answers.

Why have you been standing on this bridge for so many days. Is there any help you require. I have been watching you and feel sorry for you. Can I get you some food.

(exclamation mark)

An **exclamation mark** is put at the end of a sentence to show something sudden or surprising. It also shows strong emotion, such as, anger, joy or disappointment.

- Get out!
- What fun!
- Oh no!
- Help me!

B. Match the pictures to the sentences. Work in pairs. Share your answers with your partner and check each other’s answers.

a.



1. What a splendid garden this is!

2. This is awful!

3. Ouch! This insect bite hurts.

b.



4. Fantastic! You solved the puzzle.

5. I just won the medal!

c.



d.



e.



Life Skills Activity

(self-awareness)

Imagine you have found a box of chocolates at home. Will you share it with your loved ones, or eat all the chocolates yourself?



sharing

